

Irrational Beliefs – Check yourself!

1. According to Ellis, what makes a belief irrational?

- A) It is always false
- B) It is self-defeating and interferes with goals
- C) Not supported by evidence
- D) It is socially unacceptable

2. Two employees receive the same negative feedback. One becomes highly distressed, while the other remains calm. Which explanation best fits the ABC model?

- A) The feedback directly determines the emotional response
- B) The employees probably experienced different activating events
- C) Their beliefs about the feedback may differ, producing different consequences
- D) One employee necessarily has an irrational personality

3. Which statement is the clearest example of awfulising rather than demandingness?

- A) “I must get this promotion.”
- B) “I really want this promotion.”
- C) “Not getting this promotion would be absolutely catastrophic.”
- D) “If I don't get promoted, I am worthless.”

4. Which transformation best represents the goal of REBT?

- A) “I will definitely succeed.” → “Everything will be fine.”
- B) “I must succeed.” → “I want to succeed, but I do not have to.”
- C) “I might fail.” → “I will succeed.”
- D) “Failure is possible.” → “Failure doesn't matter.”

5. Someone believes their lucky charm improves their performance. There is no evidence that the charm changes the outcome directly, but using it increases their confidence. What does this best illustrate?

- A) The belief is rational by content and irrational by function
- B) The belief is irrational by both content and function
- C) The belief may be irrational by content but rational by function
- D) The belief must be rational because performance improved

6. Which statement best reflects the research presented on irrational beliefs and mental-health outcomes?

- A. Irrational beliefs are associated with several forms of psychological distress, although different irrational beliefs may relate differently to specific outcomes.
- B. Irrational beliefs are mainly associated with depression, while their relationship with anxiety and anger is less established.
- C. Irrational beliefs are associated with psychological distress primarily when they involve low frustration tolerance.
- D. Irrational beliefs show a general relationship with psychological distress, suggesting that the specific type of belief is largely unimportant.

7. Which question represents a functional dispute of an irrational belief?

- A) “Where is the evidence for this belief?”
- B) “Does this conclusion logically follow?”
- C) “Is this belief objectively true?”
- D) “Does this belief help me achieve my goals?”

8. Which finding most directly challenges a simple classification of religion as irrational?

- A) Religious beliefs involve supernatural claims
- B) Extrinsic religiosity is associated with poorer mental-health outcomes
- C) Different religions contain different doctrines
- D) Intrinsic and quest religiosity can be associated with characteristics Ellis considered psychologically healthy

9. Which statement best reflects the later development of Ellis’ irrational-belief theory?

- A) Later research treated demandingness, awfulising, low frustration tolerance, and global evaluation as distinguishable processes
- B) Demandingness was proven to always cause all other irrational beliefs
- C) Awfulising replaced demandingness as the only primary irrational belief
- D) Later research rejected the existence of irrational beliefs

10. Which statement best represents the more nuanced conclusion of the presentation regarding irrationality?

- A. Any belief unsupported by scientific evidence is psychologically harmful
- B. Rationality is determined entirely by whether a belief is factually true
- C. Irrational beliefs are generally associated with poorer psychological outcomes, but the concept and its proposed structure remain open to empirical and theoretical criticism
- D. Any religious, superstitious, or luck-related belief should automatically be classified as irrational

Answers:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
B	C	C	B	C	A	D	D	A	C